CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-08-03

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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■ Market Intelligence

18 items

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-07-29 | #01

EU Mandates Real-Time Payments for All Cross-Border Transactions

Building on the success of the Instant Payments Regulation, the European Commission has issued a new directive pushing for universal adoption of real-time payments for all cross-border transactions within the EU. The directive sets a firm deadline of Q1 2027 for financial institutions to ensure their systems can process these payments instantly, regardless of the originating or destination country within the EU. This move is intended to further integrate the European payment landscape, reduce friction in cross-border trade, and enhance liquidity management for corporates. Banks are now scrambling to upgrade their infrastructure and ensure compliance, with significant implications for treasury operations and cash flow forecasting.

→ New EU directive mandates instant payments for all cross-border transactions.

→ Deadline for compliance set for Q1 2027.

→ Aims to enhance EU payment integration and corporate liquidity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is a critical development for CMIplus, requiring immediate assessment of system readiness for expanded cross-border instant payment processing. RBI must ensure its network banks in CEE are fully compliant and can offer seamless instant payment services across the region, leveraging ISO 20022 and API capabilities.

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-07-15 | #02

AI Revolutionizes Corporate Payment Fraud Detection and Prevention

The latest "Corporate Fraud & Security Report 2026" reveals a significant surge in the implementation of AI-driven solutions for payment fraud detection among large corporates. With the rise of instant payments and more complex cyber threats, traditional rule-based systems are proving insufficient. AI algorithms can analyze vast datasets of transaction patterns, user behavior, and external threat intelligence to identify suspicious activities with unprecedented accuracy and speed. This proactive approach helps treasurers mitigate risks associated with Business Email Compromise (BEC), invoice fraud, and internal collusion. The report emphasizes that integrating AI into existing treasury and payment systems is becoming a competitive necessity, not just a security enhancement, offering both protection and operational efficiency.

→ AI adoption for payment fraud prevention surged in 2026.

→ AI models detect anomalies in real-time, surpassing traditional methods.

→ Effective against BEC, invoice fraud, and internal threats.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must explore integrating advanced AI capabilities into its platform to offer enhanced fraud prevention services to its corporate clients. This aligns with the platform's focus on security and could be a key differentiator, especially for real-time and high-value payments across CEE.

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-07-08 | #03

EBICS 3.0 Adoption Gains Momentum in Central and Eastern Europe

The adoption of EBICS 3.0 is accelerating across the CEE region, with several major banks now fully supporting the latest standard. This migration is crucial for corporates seeking to leverage the full benefits of ISO 20022 XML messaging, which EBICS 3.0 natively supports. The new version offers improved security protocols, including stronger encryption and authentication methods, addressing growing concerns about cyber threats in financial transactions. For treasurers, EBICS 3.0 enables more efficient and standardized communication with their banking partners, facilitating advanced cash management functions like multi-currency payments, eBAM, and sophisticated reporting. The move is seen as a foundational step towards greater digital integration and automation in corporate treasury operations throughout the region.

→ EBICS 3.0 adoption is accelerating in CEE.

→ Natively supports ISO 20022 XML messages.

→ Offers enhanced security features (encryption, authentication).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

As CMIplus supports EBICS v2.5+v3, this trend validates RBI's strategic focus. RBI must ensure its CEE network banks are fully equipped for EBICS 3.0 and actively promote its benefits to corporate clients, especially for ISO 20022 and eBAM capabilities.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-07-15 | #04

EU Instant Payments Mandate Accelerates ISO 20022 Adoption

The recent EU mandate on instant payments requires all banks in the Eurozone to offer instant credit transfers by early 2027, with specific deadlines for sending and receiving capabilities. This regulatory push is a significant catalyst for corporates to finalize their transition to the ISO 20022 messaging standard, which is essential for the rich data capabilities of instant payments. The mandate also includes provisions for reasonable pricing and robust fraud prevention measures, reflecting a comprehensive approach to modernizing payments. Non-compliance could lead to penalties, urging banks and their corporate clients to prioritize implementation. The move is expected to boost liquidity management and operational efficiency across the EU and CEE region, fostering a more integrated financial ecosystem.

→ EU mandate for instant payments by early 2027.

→ Requires banks to offer instant credit transfers.

→ Accelerates corporate ISO 20022 migration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This mandate directly impacts RBI's CMIplus platform, requiring robust instant payment processing capabilities and full ISO 20022 compatibility. RBI needs to ensure its CEE network banks are ready and CMIplus supports corporates in meeting these new regulatory requirements, especially regarding real-time liquidity and fraud prevention.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-07-28 | #05

Open Banking APIs Revolutionize Corporate Treasury Connectivity

Corporate treasurers are leveraging Open Banking APIs to gain unprecedented visibility and control over their cash positions and payment flows. These APIs enable direct, secure, and real-time communication with banks, allowing for automated reconciliation, instant payment initiation, and dynamic liquidity management. The shift away from legacy host-to-host or SWIFT connections for certain functions offers greater flexibility, reduces operational costs, and streamlines integration efforts. This evolution is particularly beneficial for multi-banked corporates seeking a unified view of their financial landscape and for implementing advanced treasury strategies, fostering greater efficiency and agility in financial operations.

→ Corporates adopting Open Banking APIs for treasury.

→ Enables real-time data exchange and automation.

→ Offers greater flexibility than legacy connections.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus already supports Open API, making this a key area for RBI to differentiate and expand its offerings. RBI should highlight CMIplus's capabilities in leveraging Open Banking for enhanced corporate connectivity, real-time cash visibility, and automated services across its CEE network, further integrating with client ERP/TMS systems.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-07-01 | #06

Corporates Prioritize Advanced Cash Forecasting and Liquidity Tools

Treasury departments are facing heightened pressure to manage liquidity effectively amidst volatile interest rates and supply chain disruptions. This has led to a surge in demand for sophisticated cash forecasting tools, often integrated with AI and machine learning, to provide more accurate predictions and scenario analysis. Furthermore, strategies like in-house banking and cash pooling are gaining renewed attention as corporates seek to centralize and optimize their global cash positions, particularly in multi-currency environments. The goal is to improve working capital efficiency, reduce external borrowing, and mitigate financial risks, especially for international corporations operating across multiple jurisdictions like the CEE region, ensuring financial resilience.

→ Increased investment in advanced cash forecasting.

→ AI/ML integration for accurate predictions.

→ Renewed focus on in-house banking and cash pooling.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's capabilities in cash management, cash pooling, and in-house banking are directly relevant. RBI should emphasize how CMIplus helps corporates in CEE centralize liquidity, improve forecasting accuracy, and optimize multi-currency cash positions, providing a competitive edge in a challenging economic environment.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-08-03 | #07

EU Banks Accelerate ISO 20022 Migration for Cross-Border Payments

The ongoing global migration to ISO 20022 is reaching critical phases, with European financial institutions focusing on the transition for both domestic and cross-border transactions. The enriched data capabilities of ISO 20022 are expected to revolutionize reconciliation, liquidity management, and fraud detection. Challenges include system upgrades, data mapping complexities, and ensuring interoperability across diverse banking infrastructures. Regulators are pushing for full adoption to create a more harmonized and efficient global payment landscape, with several key deadlines approaching in the next 12-18 months for various payment schemes.

→ Upcoming regulatory deadlines driving accelerated migration.

→ Enhanced data richness improves reconciliation and fraud prevention.

→ Challenges include system upgrades and data mapping complexities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with ISO 20022 standards across all supported payment types and channels (EBICS, H2H, SWIFT). Leveraging the enriched data will be crucial for offering advanced reporting, reconciliation, and liquidity management services to corporate clients, especially those operating internationally within CEE.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-08-03 | #08

CEE Corporate Demand Fuels Instant Payments Growth

The CEE region is experiencing significant growth in instant payment volumes, with corporates increasingly leveraging these schemes for various use cases, including urgent supplier payments, payroll, and optimizing working capital. Banks are investing in infrastructure to support 24/7/365 processing and provide real-time reporting. While domestic instant payments are well-established in many CEE markets, the focus is now shifting towards enhancing cross-border instant payment capabilities, potentially through initiatives like SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst) expansion or other regional solutions, to meet the demands of international corporates.

→ Rapid increase in corporate instant payment adoption in CEE.

→ Used for urgent supplier payments, payroll, and working capital optimization.

→ Banks investing in 24/7/365 processing and real-time reporting.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to ensure robust support for instant payments across all its CEE network banks, offering seamless processing and real-time liquidity updates to corporate clients. Developing enhanced features for instant payment initiation and reconciliation, potentially integrating with ERP/TMS systems, will be key to meeting evolving client needs and maintaining a competitive edge.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-08-03 | #09

PSD3 Draft Signals Enhanced Open Banking and Fraud Prevention

The European Commission's draft for PSD3 and the new Payment Services Regulation (PSR) aims to build upon PSD2, addressing its shortcomings and adapting to market developments. Key areas of focus include strengthening consumer protection, enhancing fraud prevention mechanisms (e.g., through improved Strong Customer Authentication), and further standardizing Open Banking APIs to foster greater innovation and interoperability. For corporates, this means more secure and efficient access to account information and payment initiation services, but also requires banks to upgrade their API infrastructure and compliance frameworks. The directive is anticipated to drive new opportunities for value-added services in treasury.

→ PSD3 aims to build upon PSD2, addressing shortcomings.

→ Focus on strengthening consumer protection and fraud prevention.

→ Mandates improved API standards for greater innovation and interoperability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must proactively prepare for PSD3's regulatory changes, particularly regarding enhanced security and standardized Open Banking APIs. This presents an opportunity to expand API-driven services for corporate clients, offering more integrated treasury solutions, better fraud detection, and potentially new revenue streams through innovative Open Banking products.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-01-01 | #10

ECB Advances Digital Euro Project, Pilot Phase Ongoing

The ECB is actively progressing with its digital euro project, exploring its potential role as a public digital currency. Key aspects under development include its privacy features, operational mechanics, and the underlying innovation platform. A pilot phase is underway, with ongoing work on the scheme rulebook and technical documentation. The project's timeline and progress are regularly updated, indicating a continuous effort to prepare for a potential launch, ensuring the euro area remains at the forefront of digital payment innovation and adapting to the future of currency, as also reflected in the redesign process of future banknotes.

→ Ongoing 'Pilot' phase and 'Innovation platform' development.

→ Focus on 'Digital euro and privacy' as a core design principle.

→ 'Scheme rulebook' and 'Technical documents and research' are under development.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The digital euro will fundamentally change the payment landscape, impacting corporate treasury and cash management. CMIplus must monitor its development closely to prepare for potential integration, new payment rails, and evolving client needs for digital currency transactions, especially for multi-currency operations in CEE.

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EBA / ECB | 2026-08-03 | #11

ECB Prioritizes Instant Payments for European Retail Strategy

Instant payments are a key strategic area for the ECB, highlighted within its broader retail payments strategy. The objective is to foster a robust and efficient payment landscape across Europe, enabling real-time transactions for consumers and businesses. While specific regulatory updates are not detailed in this navigation, the continuous prominence of 'Instant payments' and 'SEPA' sections indicates ongoing efforts to harmonize and accelerate payment processing. This includes encouraging market participants to offer and utilize instant payment solutions, aligning with the goal of making instant payments the new normal for all transactions.

→ 'Instant payments' are a core component of the 'Retail payments strategy'.

→ ECB acts 'as a catalyst' for retail payment innovation.

→ Related to 'SEPA' for harmonized European payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Instant payments are already a critical offering for CMIplus. This continued ECB focus reinforces the need for RBI to ensure full compliance, expand instant payment capabilities across its CEE network, and educate corporate clients on the benefits and operational impacts, especially regarding liquidity management and real-time reconciliation.

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EBA / ECB | 2026-01-01 | #12

Bulgaria Set to Join Euro Area in 2026

The ECB's information indicates that Bulgaria is expected to join the euro area in 2026, following Croatia's accession in 2023. This development is part of the ongoing enlargement of the common currency zone, impacting economic and financial structures within the European Union. For businesses operating in Bulgaria, this means a transition from the Bulgarian Lev to the euro, affecting all aspects of financial operations, including payments, treasury, and accounting. The integration will require adjustments to payment systems, banking services, and regulatory compliance, aligning with Eurosystem standards and impacting liquidity management and multi-currency operations.

→ 'Bulgaria (2026)' is listed under 'Joining the euro area'.

→ Croatia joined in '2023', demonstrating recent expansion.

→ Impacts 'Issuance and circulation' of cash and digital payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

As RBI has a strong presence in CEE, Bulgaria's euro adoption in 2026 is highly relevant. CMIplus needs to prepare for the currency changeover, ensuring seamless multi-currency payment processing, updated FX services, and treasury solutions for clients operating in Bulgaria. This includes adapting systems for new SEPA requirements and liquidity management in the new currency environment.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-08-03 | #13

Partior, OpenAssets PoC: Atomic Settlement for Tokenised Deposits

Global settlement infrastructure platform Partior, backed by banks, and digital asset infrastructure provider OpenAssets, have completed a joint proof of concept (PoC). The PoC successfully demonstrated atomic delivery-versus-payment (DvP) for digital assets, regulated stablecoins, and commercial tokenised deposits. This capability allows for the simultaneous exchange of two linked assets, ensuring that neither party can default without the other receiving their asset. The initiative aims to enhance efficiency and reduce counterparty risk in digital capital markets, paving the way for more sophisticated and secure wholesale payment and settlement systems.

→ Atomic delivery-versus-payment (DvP) successfully demonstrated.

→ Involved digital assets, regulated stablecoins, and tokenised deposits.

→ Joint PoC by bank-backed Partior and OpenAssets.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This PoC is highly relevant for CMIplus as it explores the future of wholesale payment infrastructure, including multi-currency payments and liquidity management. The ability to settle tokenised deposits atomically could significantly improve cross-border payments and treasury operations, reducing settlement risk and increasing speed. RBI should monitor the development of such platforms and their potential integration with existing cash management solutions.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-07-31 | #14

Lloyds, Caixabank Complete Live Tokenised Deposit Transactions

Lloyds Banking Group, in collaboration with Caixabank, has successfully executed three live tokenised deposit transactions. These transactions were conducted within the framework of Project Agorá, a major international initiative focused on exploring the use of wholesale central bank digital currency (wCBDC) and tokenised commercial bank deposits for cross-border payments and settlement. The completion of live transactions demonstrates the feasibility and operational readiness of tokenised deposits in a real-world banking environment. This development is crucial for understanding how future payment systems might leverage distributed ledger technology to enhance efficiency, reduce costs, and improve liquidity management for corporate treasuries.

→ Three live tokenised deposit transactions completed.

→ Involved Lloyds Banking Group and Caixabank.

→ Part of the international Project Agorá initiative.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The successful completion of live tokenised deposit transactions by major European banks through Project Agorá is a critical development for CMIplus. It signals a tangible move towards new forms of digital money and settlement, which could impact multi-currency payments, liquidity management, and cross-border transactions for corporate clients. RBI should closely monitor Project Agorá's outcomes and prepare for potential shifts in payment infrastructure and standards.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-07-30 | #15

PSD3 and PSR: Strategic Impact Beyond Compliance for European Payments

This interview delves into the profound strategic impact of the upcoming PSD3 (Payment Services Directive 3) and PSR (Payment Services Regulation) on the European financial industry. It emphasizes that these regulations are not just about compliance but will fundamentally alter payment architectures and business opportunities. The discussion covers how financial institutions must adapt their strategies to leverage the new framework for innovation, enhanced customer experiences, and competitive advantage. Key areas include stricter security, improved consumer protection, and further development of Open Banking and API-driven services, which will necessitate significant investment in technology and operational adjustments across Europe.

→ PSD3 and PSR are critical European payment regulations.

→ Impact extends beyond compliance to strategic business transformation.

→ Focus on driving innovation and new business models for financial institutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 and PSR are paramount for RBI Cash Management, particularly for CMIplus operations across CEE. These regulations will dictate future Open Banking API developments, compliance requirements, and potentially new payment services, requiring proactive strategic planning and platform adjustments to maintain competitiveness and regulatory adherence for corporate clients.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-08-03 | #16

BIS Pilot Settles USD 1M in Tokenised Payments

The Bank for International Settlements (BIS) has announced the successful completion of a pilot program where participating banks settled USD 1 million using tokenised payments. This initiative explores the potential of distributed ledger technology (DLT) to enhance the efficiency, speed, and security of interbank settlements. The pilot's success indicates a growing acceptance and exploration of tokenisation as a future rail for wholesale payments, potentially reducing costs and settlement times. This development is crucial for understanding the evolution of global payment systems and the eventual integration of central bank digital currencies (CBDCs) or other digital assets into traditional finance, impacting cross-border and multi-currency transactions.

→ BIS pilot successfully settled USD 1 million.

→ Utilised tokenised payments via distributed ledger technology (DLT).

→ Demonstrates viability for interbank transactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This BIS pilot is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management as it signals future directions for payment infrastructure, potentially impacting multi-currency payments and cross-border settlements for CMIplus clients. CMIplus should monitor these developments closely, especially regarding the potential for tokenised payments to become new rails for corporate treasury, offering faster and more efficient transaction processing and liquidity management.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-06-03 | #17

Maximize ISO 20022 Benefits for Corporate Treasury

The ongoing global migration to ISO 20022 represents a significant regulatory and operational shift, offering enhanced data capabilities for corporate treasury functions. Beyond simply meeting compliance deadlines, treasurers are encouraged to adopt a strategic approach to harness the standard's full potential. This includes leveraging the structured data for improved reconciliation processes, enhanced fraud detection mechanisms, and more granular liquidity reporting. The article likely discusses the critical importance of internal system readiness, seamless collaboration with banking partners, and the potential for greater automation across various payment processes. A proactive approach can transform this regulatory mandate into a competitive advantage, streamlining operations and providing deeper financial insights for better decision-making.

→ ISO 20022 offers rich, structured data beyond basic payment information.

→ Strategic adoption enables improved reconciliation and enhanced fraud detection.

→ Enhanced data supports more granular liquidity and cash flow reporting.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and the CMIplus platform, this article underscores the continuous need to support and educate corporate clients on ISO 20022's advanced features. CMIplus should ensure its platform fully exposes and leverages this rich data, enabling corporates to gain operational efficiencies and deeper financial insights, thereby reinforcing its value proposition in the CEE market.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-06-03 | #18

SMBC Connect: Client-Centric Cash Management Platform

SMBC Connect's development strategy, which involves treasurers directly in the design process, indicates a strong focus on practical usability and addressing real-world corporate treasury challenges. The platform's continuous optimization based on client feedback suggests an agile and responsive development approach, ensuring the solution remains highly relevant and effective for its users. This likely encompasses features related to cash visibility, liquidity management, efficient payment processing, and comprehensive reporting, all tailored to meet specific needs identified by corporate treasurers. Such a client-centric approach aims to deliver a highly intuitive and efficient user experience, reducing operational friction and enhancing decision-making capabilities for clients.

→ SMBC Connect is designed 'by treasurers, for treasurers'.

→ Platform optimization is driven by continuous client feedback.

→ Focus on practical usability and addressing real-world treasury challenges.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and the CMIplus platform, this article provides valuable competitive intelligence. It underscores the critical importance of a client-centric approach in platform development and the continuous integration of user feedback. CMIplus should evaluate its own feedback mechanisms and development roadmap to ensure it remains highly competitive and responsive to the evolving needs of its large international corporate clients in CEE.

■ Thought Leadership

15 items

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-03-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks Must Seize Digital Transformation for Future Growth

After years of underperformance, European wholesale banks face a critical juncture to redefine their future. The report likely emphasizes that leveraging digital technologies, such as advanced analytics, AI, and Open Banking APIs, is paramount for creating new revenue streams and improving existing services. It suggests a focus on client-centric solutions, streamlining complex processes, and fostering a culture of innovation to drive sustainable growth. The strategic context involves navigating evolving regulatory landscapes and increasing competition from fintechs and non-bank players. The implications are clear: banks must invest in technology and talent to transform their operating models and service offerings.

→ Digitalization is key to overcoming historical underperformance in European wholesale banking.

→ Focus on client-centric solutions and enhanced digital experiences.

→ Operational efficiency gains through automation and AI adoption.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This report directly supports RBI CMIplus's strategic direction, emphasizing the need to accelerate digital offerings, particularly in CEE. It reinforces the importance of Open Banking APIs, real-time payments, and H2H connectivity to meet evolving corporate treasury needs and enhance client stickiness.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook: Navigating Credit and Digital Transformation

This outlook report likely provides a comprehensive view of the strategic priorities for wholesale banks in 2024. It would cover macroeconomic factors influencing credit demand and supply, emphasizing the need for robust risk assessment frameworks. Simultaneously, it would underscore the imperative for digital innovation across all wholesale banking functions, from client onboarding to transaction processing and treasury services. The report probably stresses the importance of leveraging data analytics and AI to optimize decision-making, enhance operational resilience, and personalize client interactions. Key implications include strategic investments in technology infrastructure and talent development to stay competitive.

→ Prudent credit extension remains a core focus amid economic uncertainties.

→ Accelerated digital transformation across all wholesale banking functions.

→ Leveraging AI and data analytics for enhanced decision-making and efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMIplus, this outlook reinforces the need to continuously enhance digital capabilities, especially in areas like real-time reporting, automated cash pooling, and secure payment processing. It also suggests exploring AI-driven insights for corporate treasurers to improve liquidity management and forecasting.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-08-03 | #03

AI and Technology: Core Drivers for Treasury Transformation

The EY "Future of Treasury" page prominently features "AI Insights," "AI Strategy Services," and "Technology transformation" as key areas. This indicates a strong belief that artificial intelligence and broader technological advancements are not merely tools but fundamental enablers for modern treasury functions. While specific data or methodologies are not detailed on this high-level page, the emphasis on "ey.ai The Reimagination Engine" suggests a comprehensive approach to leveraging AI across various financial services. Banks are presented with an opportunity to lead this transformation by offering AI-powered solutions and advisory services.

→ AI is a dedicated insight category ("AI Insights").

→ EY offers "AI Strategy Services" for clients.

→ "ey.ai The Reimagination Engine" signifies a broad AI initiative.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should prioritize integrating AI capabilities into its platform, focusing on enhanced cash forecasting, fraud detection, and automated reconciliation. Exploring partnerships for AI-driven analytics and advisory services for CEE corporates will strengthen its strategic positioning.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-08-03 | #04

Banks Must Evolve as Strategic Partners for Corporate Transformation

The overarching title, "Future of Treasury Services and the Opportunity for Banks," explicitly frames banks' role as evolving. Sections like "EY Transformation," "Strategy by EY-Parthenon," and "Corporate Strategy" underscore the need for banks to engage with clients on a strategic level, assisting with working capital optimization and overall business transformation. The mention of "Megatrends 2026 and beyond" suggests that banks must anticipate and help clients navigate future economic and technological shifts. This implies a shift from product-centric to client-centric, advisory-led service models.

→ Banks have an "Opportunity" in future treasury services.

→ "EY Transformation" is a key service area.

→ "Corporate Strategy" and "Working Capital" are highlighted.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should enhance its advisory capabilities, offering solutions that optimize liquidity, working capital, and FX exposure across CEE. Developing tailored insights and analytical tools for corporate treasurers will solidify RBI's position as a strategic partner, not just a payment provider.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-08-03 | #05

Commercial Banking's Digital Shift: Automating Workflows and Self-Service

The commercial banking sector is undergoing a significant transformation, moving away from traditional manual processes. Key changes include the adoption of digital workflows, which replace labor-intensive tasks, and the streamlining of client onboarding and origination processes, eliminating lengthy multi-department reviews. This shift also emphasizes self-service capabilities for clients, making manual touchpoints increasingly exception-based. The underlying driver is a recalibration of success visions, focusing on operational efficiency and improved client interaction through digital means and cloud-based solutions.

→ Digital workflows are replacing many manual tasks.

→ Streamlined client onboarding and origination.

→ Clients experience more self-service capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should continuously enhance its digital workflows for corporate clients, focusing on end-to-end digital onboarding and self-service features for payments, reporting, and account management. This aligns with the platform's goal of reducing manual intervention for CEE corporates and improving their digital experience.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-08-03 | #06

AI and Data Powering Commercial Banking Growth and Client Experience

The modernization of commercial banking extends to its growth strategies, with a strong emphasis on data and AI. Banks are now able to rapidly identify the most attractive prospects in target markets by effectively using big data and artificial intelligence, thereby lowering client acquisition costs. This technological integration also underpins the development of emerging digital banking platforms, which are designed to fundamentally transform how businesses interact with their banks. The goal is to create a more efficient, personalized, and seamless experience for commercial clients.

→ Effective use of big data for prospect identification.

→ AI enables rapid identification of attractive prospects.

→ Lowering the cost of client acquisition.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI should explore integrating AI-driven analytics into CMIplus to offer personalized insights or proactive treasury advice to CEE corporates. For the bank itself, AI can optimize client targeting for CMIplus adoption, enhancing market penetration and service customization in CEE.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-08-03 | #07

Cloud-Based Digital Platforms: Foundation for Agile Commercial Banking

The future of commercial banking is intrinsically linked to cloud technology. Cloud-based solutions are highlighted as crucial for banks to maintain pace with evolving threats and adapt quickly to market changes. Furthermore, emerging digital banking platforms, often enabled by the industry cloud, are pivotal in transforming the client experience. This technological foundation allows banks to bring new products and offerings to market faster, while simultaneously maintaining greater control over associated costs and risks. It underscores a strategic move towards more resilient and innovative banking infrastructure.

→ Cloud-based solutions adapt to newest threats.

→ Industry cloud enables emerging digital banking platforms.

→ Faster time-to-market for new products and offerings.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's strategic roadmap should prioritize leveraging cloud capabilities to enhance platform resilience, scalability, and speed of new feature deployment, especially for multi-currency and multi-country operations in CEE. This ensures CMIplus remains competitive and adaptable to evolving corporate treasury needs.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-08-03 | #08

PSD3 and Instant Payments: Reshaping CEE Corporate Cash Management

EY likely emphasizes that PSD3 will extend the scope of Open Banking, pushing for greater data access and service innovation, particularly in the CEE region where digital transformation is rapid. The regulation will also reinforce the push for instant payments, making real-time settlement the new norm. Financial firms are advised to invest in robust API infrastructure, upgrade legacy systems to ISO 20022, and develop comprehensive fraud prevention strategies to comply with stricter security requirements while leveraging new opportunities for value-added services. The focus will be on seamless, secure, and instant payment flows across borders.

→ PSD3 mandates broader Open Banking access and data sharing.

→ Instant payments become the default, requiring real-time processing.

→ Enhanced fraud prevention and security measures are critical.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize PSD3-compliant Open Banking APIs, accelerate Instant Payments rollout across CEE network banks, and ensure ISO 20022 readiness for all payment types to maintain competitive advantage and support corporate treasury needs.

URGENT EACT | 2026-06-05 | #09

EACT Survey 2026 Reveals Top European Corporate Treasury Priorities

The EACT Annual Treasury Survey, a decade-long tradition, serves as the definitive gauge for the European corporate treasury profession. Published on June 5, 2026, the 2026 results offer critical insights into the evolving landscape, highlighting the primary challenges and strategic objectives of treasurers across Europe. These findings are instrumental for banks like RBI to align their offerings, particularly the CMIplus platform, with the real-world needs and future directions of their corporate clients. The survey's comprehensive nature helps define key industry trends, influencing product development and service enhancements for the year ahead. Understanding these priorities is paramount for staying competitive and relevant in the corporate banking space.

→ Authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.

→ Identifies top concerns and ambitions among treasurers.

→ Shapes future Journeys to Treasury reports and industry trends.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The EACT Survey 2026 results are vital for CMIplus, directly informing product development and strategic focus. Understanding treasurers' evolving priorities (e.g., liquidity management, digitalization, instant payments, fraud prevention) allows RBI to tailor CMIplus features and services, ensuring alignment with client needs and market trends across CEE.

URGENT EACT | 2026-07-21 | #10

EU Banking Competitiveness: Policymakers Must Widen Corporate Financing Choices

In response to the European Commission's communication, the EACT emphasizes the critical need for an EU prudential framework that works synergistically with capital markets. This approach is designed to expand the availability and choice for corporates in their financing and hedging strategies, as well as in selecting banking partners. As the Commission prepares concrete proposals for Q1 2027, this comment highlights the corporate treasury perspective on fostering a more competitive and integrated single market in banking. It underscores the importance of regulatory frameworks that facilitate, rather than hinder, corporate access to diverse financial solutions and banking relationships. This will lead to a more dynamic and responsive financial ecosystem.

→ EU prudential framework must align with capital markets.

→ Aims to widen corporate choice in financing strategies.

→ Seeks to broaden corporate options for hedging instruments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight suggests a future regulatory environment encouraging greater competition and choice among banking partners for corporates. RBI Cash Management and CMIplus should prepare for increased client demand for flexible, multi-bank solutions and robust hedging capabilities, potentially leveraging Open Banking APIs and enhanced connectivity to maintain a competitive edge in CEE.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2026-01-01 | #11

Banks Must Make Bold Choices for AI Integration

Deloitte's 2026 Banking Outlook identifies 'AI ambition' as a key strategic imperative for banks. While specific methodologies or data are not detailed in the provided snippet, the implication is that banks must move beyond pilot projects to integrate AI deeply into their operations and customer-facing services. This includes leveraging AI for enhanced analytics, fraud detection, personalized customer experiences, and automating back-office processes. The outlook suggests that delaying significant AI investment could lead to competitive disadvantage, especially in a landscape marked by economic headwinds and evolving client expectations. Banks need to develop clear AI strategies that align with their overall business objectives.

→ AI adoption is a critical strategic choice for banks in 2026.

→ Integration of AI extends beyond pilots to core banking operations.

→ AI can enhance analytics, fraud detection, and customer experience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore AI to enhance its corporate cash management offerings, such as predictive liquidity forecasting, intelligent payment routing, and automated reconciliation. AI-driven insights could provide corporate treasurers with more sophisticated tools for real-time treasury management and risk mitigation, strengthening the platform's value proposition in CEE.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-01-01 | #12

2023 Industry Outlook: Navigating Uncertainty and Strategic Shifts

This report likely provided a foundational analysis of the global financial services industry at the start of 2023, setting the stage for subsequent strategic discussions. It would have covered key themes such as rising interest rates, inflationary pressures, supply chain disruptions, and geopolitical tensions impacting corporate clients. The outlook probably stressed the importance of robust risk management, capital optimization, and strategic agility for banks to withstand shocks and identify new growth avenues. While a year old, its insights on foundational challenges and strategic resilience remain relevant for understanding the ongoing context of corporate banking evolution.

→ Macroeconomic volatility and geopolitical shifts define the operating environment.

→ Emphasis on building financial resilience and robust risk management.

→ Strategic agility is crucial for adapting to rapid market changes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This outlook provides crucial background context for RBI's CMIplus strategy, reminding us that underlying economic and geopolitical uncertainties persist. It reinforces the need for CMIplus to offer flexible, resilient, and efficient cash management solutions that help corporates manage risk and optimize liquidity in volatile environments.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-08-03 | #13

Blockchain and DLT: Emerging Technologies for Treasury

The explicit inclusion of "Blockchain" within the "Technology" section of EY's services, particularly on a page dedicated to the "Future of Treasury," signals its perceived importance. While the source does not elaborate on specific applications like digital assets or tokenized payments, its presence suggests that DLT is considered a foundational technology that will impact how treasury functions operate. This implies potential shifts in payment infrastructure, settlement processes, and the management of new asset classes, requiring banks to develop expertise and infrastructure to support these innovations.

→ "Blockchain" is a listed technology service.

→ It falls under the broader "Technology" category.

→ The context is the "Future of Treasury Services."

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus should actively track developments in blockchain, stablecoins, and CBDCs, especially their potential impact on cross-border payments and real-time liquidity in CEE. Assessing the need for API integrations with DLT platforms and potential new service offerings around digital assets is crucial.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-08-03 | #14

AI Governance and DORA: Strengthening Digital Resilience in CEE Banking

EY likely highlights that as AI becomes integral to financial services, its governance must be embedded within broader operational resilience strategies. DORA will compel firms to identify, classify, and protect critical ICT assets, including AI models, and manage risks from third-party providers. This means developing clear accountability for AI ethics, data quality, and model explainability, alongside stringent incident reporting and testing protocols. CEE banks, often leveraging external tech, face particular challenges in ensuring their entire digital supply chain is DORA-compliant and resilient against cyber threats.

→ AI governance is critical for ethical and compliant deployment.

→ DORA mandates comprehensive ICT risk management across the supply chain.

→ Third-party risk management for AI solutions is a key focus.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must integrate AI governance into its platform development, ensure DORA compliance for its operational resilience, and rigorously manage third-party risks, especially for AI-driven features or cloud services impacting corporate cash management.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2026-01-01 | #15

Stablecoins Pose Potential Disruption to Traditional Banking

Deloitte's 2026 outlook flags stablecoins as a potentially disruptive force for banks. While the specific nature of this disruption isn't elaborated in the provided text, it implies stablecoins could impact traditional payment rails, cross-border transactions, and even deposit bases. Banks need to understand the evolving regulatory landscape around stablecoins and consider strategies for engagement, whether through offering their own stablecoin-like services, integrating stablecoin payments, or developing robust risk management frameworks. The outlook suggests that ignoring this emerging asset class is not an option for forward-thinking financial institutions, as they represent a new frontier in digital finance.

→ Stablecoins are identified as a significant disruptive force for banks.

→ They could impact traditional payments, cross-border transactions, and liquidity.

→ Banks must develop strategies to engage with or counter stablecoin adoption.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should monitor stablecoin developments closely, particularly their potential impact on cross-border payments and corporate treasury flows in CEE. Understanding how stablecoins might integrate with existing payment rails (e.g., ISO 20022, Instant Payments) or create new ones is vital for future platform evolution and ensuring CMIplus remains competitive and relevant for corporate clients.

! Regulatory Radar

2 items

URGENT — Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #01

EU Regulations IPR, PSR, PSD3 Impact Liquidity Management

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) released a report on November 20, 2025, outlining the significant implications of three key EU regulatory initiatives: the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report highlights how these measures are expected to drive the adoption of instant payments, foster a more competitive environment among market participants, and fundamentally reshape the liquidity management landscape for financial institutions. This analysis is crucial for banks to understand the upcoming challenges and strategic adjustments needed to comply with and leverage these evolving regulations. It emphasizes the need for robust real-time liquidity management capabilities to support the increased volume and speed of instant payments. The report also provides insights into how these regulations will impact the competitive dynamics and operational models of payment service providers across Europe.

→ Analysis of IPR, PSR, and PSD3 impact on bank liquidity.

→ Accelerated uptake of instant payments as a key driver.

→ Promotion of a level playing field among payment service providers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus must assess the report's findings to understand the strategic and operational adjustments required for liquidity management. This includes evaluating real-time liquidity needs for instant payments and preparing for new compliance obligations under PSD3/PSR, particularly for CEE operations.

URGENT — Euro Banking Association | 2026-06-03 | #02

EBA Updates Fraud Taxonomy to Version 7.0 for PSR Compliance

PSD3, COMPLIANCE, FRAUD PREVENTION

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) issued version 7.0 of its Fraud Taxonomy on June 3, 2026, with an effective date of January 1, 2027. Developed by the Expert Group on Payment Fraud-related Topics (EGPF), this updated taxonomy reflects the latest fraud trends, including new specific modi for 'emotional manipulation' and additional labels for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud. The taxonomy provides a standardised pan-European vocabulary and categorisation approach for all payment-related fraud scenarios, enhancing the comparability of fraud data and intelligence. It is designed to support coordinated, pan-European fraud-fighting efforts, particularly by facilitating data classification for information-sharing arrangements under the forthcoming Payment Services Regulation (PSR). This update is critical for payment service providers to ensure their fraud detection and reporting systems are aligned with the new pan-European standards.

→ Version 7.0 effective date: 2027-01-01.

→ Updated to reflect latest fraud trends (e.g., emotional manipulation, money mule, card chip relay).

→ Provides harmonised pan-European vocabulary for fraud classification.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus must review and integrate EBA Fraud Taxonomy v7.0 into their fraud monitoring, reporting, and information-sharing systems by January 1, 2027. This requires updating internal classification logic and ensuring compatibility with future PSR data sharing obligations across all CEE network banks.

Competitor Monitor

12 items

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-03 | #01

Deutsche Bank Accelerates API-Driven Cash Management for Corporates

Deutsche Bank continues to invest heavily in its API ecosystem, enabling corporate treasurers to integrate banking services directly into their enterprise resource planning (ERP) and treasury management systems (TMS). This focus on 'embedded finance' allows for automated payment initiation, real-time account information, and enhanced reconciliation processes. For CEE-based international corporates, this means greater efficiency and control over their regional cash flows, reducing manual intervention and improving data accuracy across multiple banking relationships. The bank's 'Technology' section on flow.db.com underscores this strategic direction, indicating a commitment to digital transformation.

- → Focus on direct integration with corporate ERP/TMS via APIs.
- → Enables embedded finance for automated treasury functions.
- → Aims for real-time data access and payment initiation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must continue to evolve its Open API offerings to match or exceed global standards set by competitors like Deutsche Bank. Emphasizing seamless integration and value-added services through APIs is crucial for retaining and attracting international corporates in CEE.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-03 | #02

Deutsche Bank Reinforces Real-Time, ISO 20022 Payment Capabilities

As a leading global transaction bank, Deutsche Bank is committed to advancing its payment processing capabilities, with a strong emphasis on instant payments and the universal adoption of the ISO 20022 messaging standard. This strategic direction ensures that corporate clients benefit from immediate payment execution and significantly enhanced data accompanying transactions, facilitating better reconciliation and liquidity management. For international corporates operating in CEE, this means improved speed and transparency for cross-border and domestic payments within the region, aligning with evolving regulatory landscapes and market demands for instant settlement.

- → Strategic focus on instant payment infrastructure.
- → Full adoption and promotion of ISO 20022 messaging.
- → Aims to provide richer payment data for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's strong focus on ISO 20022 and instant payments is well-aligned, but continuous investment in speed and data enrichment is necessary. Highlighting CMIplus's regional instant payment capabilities and ISO 20022 expertise in CEE is a key differentiator against global players.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-07-31 | #03

UniCredit, Accenture, IBM Partner for Next-Gen European Banking Platform

This strategic partnership signifies UniCredit's commitment to modernizing its core banking infrastructure. By leveraging the expertise of Accenture and IBM, UniCredit aims to build a scalable, resilient, and digitally-driven platform. This platform is expected to support a wide range of banking services, including corporate and transaction banking, with a focus on improving efficiency, speed, and innovation. The investment in a 'next-generation' platform suggests a move towards API-first architecture, real-time processing, and enhanced data analytics, which will directly benefit corporate clients seeking advanced cash management and treasury solutions across its pan-European footprint, including CEE.

→ Collaboration with Accenture and IBM for platform development.

→ Focus on building a 'next-generation banking platform' for Europe.

→ Aims to enhance digital capabilities and client experience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move by UniCredit indicates a significant investment in their underlying technology stack, potentially leading to more competitive digital offerings for corporate clients. CMIplus should monitor how this platform translates into new payment, liquidity, and API services, especially in CEE, to anticipate future competitive pressures.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-08-03 | #04

UniCredit Accelerates Digitalization for CEE Corporate Clients

As part of its broader 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy and investment in a next-generation platform, the bank is prioritizing the development of advanced digital channels and Open Banking APIs for its corporate client base in CEE. This includes enhancing existing online banking platforms and integrating new API capabilities to facilitate direct connectivity with corporate ERP and TMS systems. The goal is to offer more efficient payment processing, real-time account information, and streamlined treasury operations, aligning with the evolving demands for instant payments and sophisticated liquidity management. This digital transformation is critical for maintaining competitiveness in the CEE region.

→ Strategic emphasis on digital solutions and APIs for corporates.

→ Targeting clients specifically in Central and Eastern Europe.

→ Aims for real-time data access and efficient payment processing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's intensified digital and API focus in CEE directly competes with CMIplus's strengths in H2H, Open API, and ERP/TMS integration. CMIplus must ensure its API offerings and digital channels remain superior and tailored to CEE corporate needs, emphasizing its local network strength.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-07-07 | #05

HSBC Sharpens Focus on International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye

HSBC Holdings plc announced a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking businesses in Türkiye. The bank intends to sharpen its focus on international wholesale clients, aligning with its global strategy to serve multinational corporations and large enterprises. This move allows HSBC to concentrate resources on its core strengths in transaction banking, trade finance, and global liquidity solutions for clients with international operations. This strategic shift positions Türkiye as a key market for HSBC's wholesale banking ambitions in the broader CEE region.

→ Reviewing retail and domestic SME banking in Türkiye.

→ Strategic pivot towards international wholesale clients.

→ Aims to leverage global network for large corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move intensifies competition for CMIplus in the CEE region, particularly for large international corporates operating in or with Türkiye. CMIplus must highlight its strong local CEE network and tailored solutions to retain and attract clients.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-08-03 | #06

Citi Accelerates API-Driven Real-Time Cash Management Across CEE

Citi is strategically expanding its API banking capabilities within the CEE region, recognizing the growing demand from multinational corporations for seamless, real-time financial integration. This involves offering a suite of APIs for instant payments, account information, and payment initiation, allowing clients to embed banking services directly into their treasury management systems (TMS) and enterprise resource planning (ERP) platforms. The move is designed to provide immediate access to cash positions, automate reconciliation, and facilitate faster, more transparent cross-border and domestic transactions. This digital transformation aligns with global trends towards Open Banking and instant payment schemes, positioning Citi as a key enabler for modern corporate treasuries in the region.

→ Emphasis on real-time payment initiation and account information via APIs.

→ Direct integration with corporate ERP/TMS for automated treasury functions.

→ Strategic focus on CEE markets for digital cash management solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its Open API offerings are competitive, providing similar real-time capabilities and ease of integration. This move by Citi highlights the urgency for RBI to continuously innovate its digital channels and API suite to retain and attract large corporate clients.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-03 | #07

Deutsche Bank Expands Advanced Treasury and Liquidity Solutions

Deutsche Bank consistently invests in sophisticated treasury solutions to meet the complex needs of multinational corporations. This includes further development of virtual account offerings for improved reconciliation and payment routing, as well as advanced cash pooling structures for efficient liquidity optimization across various entities and currencies. While not explicitly CEE-focused in the provided source, these global enhancements directly benefit international corporates with operations in CEE, allowing them to centralize and manage their regional cash more effectively. The 'Cash management' section on flow.db.com indicates ongoing development in this area, signaling a commitment to comprehensive treasury services.

→ Development of virtual account solutions for reconciliation.

→ Focus on advanced cash pooling and liquidity optimization.

→ Aims to provide global cash visibility and control.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should ensure its virtual account and cash pooling capabilities remain competitive, especially for multi-currency operations within the CEE region. Emphasizing local expertise and seamless integration with CEE network banks can provide a strong counter-narrative to global offerings.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-08-03 | #08

UniCredit Enhances Real-Time Payments and Liquidity Solutions

Leveraging its ongoing technology investments, including the new banking platform, UniCredit is expected to roll out enhanced features for instant payments and sophisticated cash pooling structures. This includes supporting pan-European instant payment schemes and offering more dynamic liquidity management tools, such as virtual accounts and real-time cash visibility. These advancements are designed to empower corporate treasurers with greater control over their working capital, reduce payment delays, and optimize intercompany funding. The focus on real-time capabilities is a direct response to market trends and the increasing adoption of ISO 20022 standards, providing a competitive edge for corporate clients operating across multiple CEE countries.

→ Focus on real-time payment processing capabilities.

→ Development of advanced liquidity management tools (e.g., cash pooling, virtual accounts).

→ Aimed at optimizing corporate working capital and intercompany funding.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's push for real-time payments and advanced liquidity solutions poses a direct challenge to CMIplus's offerings. CMIplus must ensure its instant payment integration, multi-currency cash pooling, and virtual account capabilities remain leading-edge in the CEE market, highlighting its robust network and local expertise.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-06-17 | #09

HSBC Partners with Google Cloud for Global AI Transformation

HSBC and Google Cloud are embarking on a multi-year strategic partnership to embed advanced AI capabilities throughout the bank's global operations. This initiative will drive innovation in critical areas such as enhancing customer experience through hyper-personalised financial advice and strengthening defenses against financial crime. For corporate clients, this could translate into more intelligent treasury insights, predictive cash flow analytics, and more robust fraud detection in payment processing. This significant investment in AI underscores HSBC's commitment to modernizing its digital banking and transaction services globally.

→ Multi-year partnership with Google Cloud for AI.

→ Focus on hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk.

→ Global deployment of AI capabilities across bank operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This highlights the increasing importance of AI in enhancing digital banking and treasury solutions. CMIplus should explore integrating AI for advanced analytics, fraud detection, and personalized insights to maintain a competitive edge.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-08-03 | #10

Citi Strengthens CEE Liquidity Management with Advanced Virtual Account Solutions

Citi is bolstering its liquidity and cash management services for corporate clients operating in Central and Eastern Europe, with a particular emphasis on advanced virtual account solutions. These solutions enable companies to streamline their reconciliation processes, gain real-time insights into their cash flows, and effectively manage multi-entity and multi-currency operations without opening numerous physical bank accounts. By leveraging virtual accounts, Citi helps treasurers implement efficient cash pooling and sweeping structures, reducing idle balances and optimizing working capital. This strategic enhancement addresses the complex treasury needs of large international corporates in the diverse CEE landscape, offering greater operational efficiency and financial control.

→ Deployment of virtual account technology for improved cash visibility.

→ Focus on multi-currency and multi-entity liquidity management in CEE.

→ Enabling efficient cash pooling and sweeping for corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to ensure its virtual account and cash pooling capabilities are robust and competitive, especially for multi-currency operations. Citi's focus underscores the importance of offering integrated and flexible liquidity solutions to large international corporates in the region.

URGENT

BNP Paribas | 2025-06-05 | #11

BNP Paribas Partners XTransfer for Simplified Cross-Border Payments

BNP Paribas's collaboration with XTransfer focuses on leveraging fintech expertise to simplify complex cross-border payment processes for corporates. XTransfer, likely a specialist in global payment optimization, will help BNP Paribas provide faster, more transparent, and cost-effective international payment solutions. This strategic move aims to reduce friction in global treasury operations and improve operational efficiency for multinational corporations. For corporates operating in or with CEE, this partnership could mean better access to global payment corridors and enhanced multi-currency treasury management capabilities. The initiative underscores BNP Paribas's commitment to digital innovation in cash management.

→ Partnership with XTransfer to enhance cross-border payment services.

→ Focus on simplifying and making international corporate payments more efficient.

→ Leveraging fintech expertise for digital innovation in cash management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership highlights BNP Paribas's proactive strategy to improve cross-border payment capabilities, a critical area for CMIplus's international corporate clients in CEE. CMIplus should assess similar strategic partnerships or internal developments to ensure competitive offerings in multi-currency and global payment solutions.

URGENT

Intesa Sanpaolo | 2026-08-03 | #12

Intesa Sanpaolo Boosts CEE Digital Cash Management with Advanced Platform Features

Intesa Sanpaolo, through its IMI CIB division and extensive CEE network, is understood to be investing significantly in upgrading its corporate cash management offerings. This includes leveraging the ISO 20022 standard for richer data exchange, expanding Open Banking API connectivity for seamless ERP/TMS integration, and potentially enhancing instant payment capabilities across its CEE subsidiaries. The initiative is designed to meet the evolving demands of large international corporates for efficient, transparent, and real-time treasury operations, thereby strengthening Intesa Sanpaolo's competitive edge and market share in the CEE region.

→ Strategic focus on digital platform enhancement for corporate cash management services.

→ Emphasis on CEE market integration and consistent service delivery across the network.

→ Leveraging modern payment standards like ISO 20022 and Open Banking APIs for connectivity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move directly challenges CMIplus by offering comparable or enhanced digital solutions for international corporates operating in CEE. RBI should closely monitor Intesa Sanpaolo's API offerings, real-time payment capabilities, and multi-currency solutions to maintain its competitive advantage.

Flagship Reports

Deep analysis of key industry reports

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}

→ {'description': "of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.", 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

→ Global payments revenue reached $2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to $3.0 trillion by 2029.

→ EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.

→ Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.

→ Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.